

THE UNIVERSITY OF ZAMBIA

SCHOOL OF HUMANITIES & SOCIAL SCIENCES

DEPARTMENT OF DEVELOPMENT STUDIES

DEV 1150: INTRODUCTION TO DEVELOPMENT STUDIES

LECTURE HANDOUT

TOPIC: POPULATION & DEVELOPMENT

Prepared by **NCHUNGO**
Email: nchungo5josephat@gmail.com
Cell: 0978999263

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OUTLINE

1. Intro
 2. What Population is
 3. Theories of Population
 4. Global and National Population trends
 5. Population and Development Nexus
 6. Conclusion
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INTRO

- ❑ Concerns about population and development have been there since post colonial era as developing countries were trying to balance between population growth and development (especially the environmental and socio-economic dimension of development).
 - ❑ In 1950s, world population was about 0.5billion.
 - ❑ As of 2020, world population was about 7.79 billion.
 - ❑ This growth is nearly exponential on a finite land (earth) causing escalating pressures (global warming) on the environment.
 - ❑ Hence the concern to study population and how it relates to development
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2. WHAT POPULATION IS

- ❑ Population is the number of species (people) living on a well defined piece of land.
- ❑ Each land/region has a well defined number of people deemed sufficient to be supported by that particular land/resources and this is called ***carrying capacity***.
- ❑ Beyond a particular carrying capacity, overpopulation prevails which may cause social and health concerns if not checked

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- ❑ The process used to know the number of people living in a particular area (country) is called *census*.
- ❑ In Zambia, every ten (10) years, a census is conducted to know the number of people living in the country.
- ❑ It is from this national statistics that we derive global population



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- ❑ Population growth rate is the increase in the population size from one year to another usually expressed in percentage
- ❑ Population growth rate is determined by getting the difference in population size for the period under consideration and dividing the answer by the population size for the previous year and then multiplying by 100. The answer is expressed in %.
- ❑ Example; the population size for country A was 1000 and 1200 in 2019 and 2020 respectively. Thus its population growth rate was.
- ❑ $1200 - 1000 = 200$; $200 / 1000 \times 100 = 20\%$

3. THEORIES OF POPULATION

- ❑ Most theories of development try to give either a **positive** or **negative** view of population to development

Malthusian Theory : propounded by Rev Thomas Robert Malthus around 1766 to 1834

- ❑ Population growth will overcome food production
- ❑ Population growth increases geometrically and exponentially e.g. 1, 5, 9, 15 while food production increases arithmetically e.g. 1, 2, 3, 4, 5
- ❑ Thus with time, and given finite land resources, there shall be no more enough land to produce food or for the growing population to live on.



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- ❑ Hence end result shall be starvation/ food insecurity
 - ❑ He thus proposed that, population be checked through preventive measures (moral restraints) such things as celibacy (abstaining from marriage), or delaying marriage and child bearing.
 - ❑ Compulsory/positive checks e.g famine, wars, disease.
 - ❑ Being a religious person, he was against use of contraceptives to control population
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- ❑ His theory was however criticised due to its lack of **technological foresight** :
- ❑ With the improvement in technology, you can produce more food on a small piece of land (intensive farming) unlike during Malthus' time of extensive farming due to limited technology
- ❑ Improvement in transport and communication makes it possible to trade in food produce faster than never before from countries of surplus to countries of deficit thus arresting hunger



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- ❑ There is an increasing number of agribusiness enterprises who have commercialised farming by producing improved varieties of crops (which were previously seasonal) and can now be produced all year round
- ❑ This was never the case during the time of Malthus



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Neo-Malthusian Theories

- ❑ These theories were based on the foundation of Malthusian theory
 - ❑ They also argue that, rapid population growth may pose a threat on not only food production but also social benefits and services on the people
 - ❑ They further share the view that population should be checked/controlled to match with available resources
 - ❑ Their major point of departure from the traditional Malthusian theory however is that, they advocate for the use of contraceptives to control the population – a trait which Malthus strongly discouraged in his theory
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Boserup Theory

- ❑ Developed by a Danish Agricultural Development Economist called Esther Boserup (1910 - 1999)
- ❑ Mainly says the opposite of Malthusian theory though inspired by it
- ❑ Argues in her theory that Population increase will cause people to produce more in agriculture to address the pressures arising from food shortages



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- ❑ Gives a positive view that, more people means more production, and more production means more harvest and food security.
 - ❑ The theory suggests that overpopulation brings about innovation as people will think outside the box to address problems associated with overpopulation
 - ❑ Further adds that, large population gives revenue to the government
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GLOBAL AND NATIONAL POPULATION TRENDS

Global trends

- ❑ World population has been rapidly increasing from about 0.5 billion in the 1950s to about 7.79 billion around 2020.
- ❑ Most growth of population has been from developing countries of the world especially in Asia, Africa and Latin America
- ❑ Developed countries like Japan, United Kingdom, Germany etc have a slower population growth rate
- ❑ The world's populous country is China seconded by India with global shares of the population of about 18.47% and 17.70% respectively and both countries have larger GDPs but lower GDP /capita and this makes them be classified as developing countries despite their high level of industrialization.

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- ❑ The one-child Policy in China has helped reduce population (the resultant being an aging population) and this responds to Malthusian Theory on population control, in this case, using policy pronouncements
- ❑ Generally, global population has posed both challenges and opportunities hence the need to strike a balance
- ❑ The United Nations Population Fund (UNFPA) is a UN agency on improving population and reproductive health worldwide



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National trends

- ❑ Zambia's population has been increasing rapidly
 - ❑ In 2000, the population was about 9million
 - ❑ In 2010, it was about 13million
 - ❑ In 2020, was estimated at about 18million making it the 65th in the world
 - ❑ Lusaka remains the most populous city (with about 2.5million people) due to urbanization
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- ❑ The general increase in population has exerted a lot of pressure on the environment as most people in rural areas cut trees to make and sell charcoal to earn a living
 - ❑ Additionally, literacy levels have improved over the years , with more people attaining higher education but there still exists a higher level of unemployment among the youth with some underemployed
 - ❑ Like many other African countries, the largest section of the population is the youth, thus more productive and active for everything depending on what you may want them to do.
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POPULATION AND DEVELOPMENT NEXUS

Some arguments on the relationship between population and development mainly stem from the Neo-Malthusian theories (Theories built on the foundation of Malthusian Theory);

- ❑ Rapid population growth makes it difficult for the provision of essential social services such as, housing, transport, sanitation, and security
- ❑ Developing countries will be unable to provide health and educational services to their people.



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- ❑ Increasing population in developing countries will lead to vast increases in the labour force, thus causing increasing unemployment.
- ❑ In developing countries most income go to consumption, leaving very little if nothing for investment due to rapid population growth.



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- ❑ Demographic dividends are gains that a country can get from its population if it invested in it well. They are as follows;
 - ❑ large population can be a huge human resource and human capital for development.
 - ❑ It is the primary 'raw' material that every country has and uses in the initial stages of development before technology takes over some jobs.
 - ❑ Large population provides labour for labour intensive industries such as shoe making and assembly and thus makes products more competitive on world markets. China and India attract labour-intensive investments as a result of the foregoing.
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- ❑ A huge population is also seen as a huge market. Market size is measured not only by GDP but also by population size because people are the consumers.
 - ❑ A large population has both producers (producing to solve people's problems) and consumers (consuming for welfare) collectively called '**prosumers**'
 - ❑ **Population bonus** is when a country's population is more productive and contributes to national development.
 - ❑ **Population onus** is when the population poses serious social and economic challenges on the country such as high demand for inadequate social services (schools and health care), high levels of crime, hunger etc. This happens when the population is not productive, thus it becomes a burden to the nation in as much as it would be to a family/household.
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CONCLUSION

- ❑ Population is a double-barrelled phenomenon
 - ❑ It yields demographic dividends if you invested in it, that is on the production side.
 - ❑ It can also become an onus if nothing was invested in it and thus not productive, only a consumer
 - ❑ It now depends on national governments to decide what they want out of their population
 - ❑ There is no idle population unless it is made so!
 - ❑ Within a large population are sleeping giants that need to be awakened by such things as education, empowerment and generally creating an enabling environment for people to realise their own potential to solve their own economic problems
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TASK FOR GROUP DISCUSSIONS

1. In which way (s) can a fast growing population be a curse and/or blessing to a country?
 2. Identify a country in Africa with the largest population and state whether or not it is enjoying demographic dividends
 3. Using the analytical lens of Malthusian theory, discuss the economic implication of China's one-child policy.
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